

# Toddler Winter Gear Battles — Action Checklist

---

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

## VERIFY CAR SEAT HARNESS SAFETY

---

- ☐ **Perform the pinch test with your toddler's winter coat buckled in the car seat, then remove the coat without adjusting the harness to see how much slack appears in the strap above the collarbone, revealing the hidden danger that the coat creates.:** Perform the pinch test with your toddler's winter coat buckled in the car seat, then remove the coat without adjusting the harness to see how much slack appears in the strap above the collarbone, revealing the hidden danger that the coat creates.
- ☐ **Replace bulky winter coats with a thin full-zip micro-fleece that allows you to fit two fingers under the car seat chest clip when the jacket is on, ensuring the harness fits properly in a crash.:** Replace bulky winter coats with a thin full-zip micro-fleece that allows you to fit two fingers under the car seat chest clip when the jacket is on, ensuring the harness fits properly in a crash.
- ☐ **Keep a spare thin fleece jacket permanently in your car so you always have a car seat-safe layer available regardless of what happens during the morning routine at home.:** Keep a spare thin fleece jacket permanently in your car so you always have a car seat-safe layer available regardless of what happens during the morning routine at home.
- ☐ **Pre-warm your car for 5 minutes before loading a toddler who refuses to sit in a cold vehicle, eliminating one source of resistance without needing a heavy coat for warmth.:** Pre-warm your car for 5 minutes before loading a toddler who refuses to sit in a cold vehicle, eliminating one source of resistance without needing a heavy coat for warmth.

## IMPLEMENT THE 2-STEP LAYER SYSTEM

---

- ☐ **Dress your toddler in only a thin fleece for the car ride and pack the heavy winter coat, hat, and gloves in your arrival bag to put on at your destination instead of before departure.:** Dress your toddler in only a thin fleece for the car ride and pack the heavy winter coat, hat, and gloves in your arrival bag to put on at your destination instead of before departure.
-

- ❑ **Place a thin blanket over your toddler's legs and lower body after properly tightening the harness, following the blanket-over-buckled-lap rule and never placing fabric over the chest or arms.:** Place a thin blanket over your toddler's legs and lower body after properly tightening the harness, following the blanket-over-buckled-lap rule and never placing fabric over the chest or arms.
- ❑ **Purchase a car seat poncho that drapes over shoulders and fastens with snaps or Velcro if your convertible or all-in-one car seat makes it difficult to dress your toddler after buckling.:** Purchase a car seat poncho that drapes over shoulders and fastens with snaps or Velcro if your convertible or all-in-one car seat makes it difficult to dress your toddler after buckling.
- ❑ **Buy two full-zip micro-fleece jackets so one stays permanently in the car and your toddler can practice independent zipping and unzipping for a satisfying independence hit.:** Buy two full-zip micro-fleece jackets so one stays permanently in the car and your toddler can practice independent zipping and unzipping for a satisfying independence hit.

## BUILD A VISUAL MORNING ROUTINE

---

- ❑ **Create a visual morning schedule with pictures showing each step of the getting-ready sequence, including the car seat layer on and the heavy coat on at arrival, so your toddler knows what comes next.:** Create a visual morning schedule with pictures showing each step of the getting-ready sequence, including the car seat layer on and the heavy coat on at arrival, so your toddler knows what comes next.
- ❑ **Position the heavy winter coat, hat, and gloves in the arrival bag rather than on your toddler before departure, removing the coat battle from the car ride entirely.:** Position the heavy winter coat, hat, and gloves in the arrival bag rather than on your toddler before departure, removing the coat battle from the car ride entirely.
- ❑ **Use a consistent sequence every morning:** thin fleece on at home, car seat buckled, heavy coat applied at arrival — so your toddler learns and anticipates the pattern.
- ❑ **Practice the full morning routine on a relaxed weekend morning without time pressure so your toddler becomes familiar with the steps before busy weekday mornings.:** Practice the full morning routine on a relaxed weekend morning without time pressure so your toddler becomes familiar with the steps before busy weekday mornings.